

BALAAJEE VR

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Chennai, India

LinkedIn Profile

PORTFOLIO & WORKS

Design Gallery (Behance)

EDUCATION

B.E. Information Technology
MS University • 2004

TEACHING & PRACTICE AREAS

HCI & SOFTWARE SYSTEMS

- Human-Computer Interaction (HCI)
- Enterprise AI-UX (Watson / GenAI)
- Design System Tokens & Architecture
- Front-End Engineering Handoff
- Systems Usability & Heuristics

PEDAGOGY & MENTORSHIP

- Full-Stack & HCI Capstone Mentorship
- Agile / PI Planning Methodologies
- Technical Hackathons & Contests
- Production SDLC & Code Quality

INSTITUTIONAL VALUE

- Industry MoUs (IBM, Ericsson, Zebra)
- Placement Readiness for Top Tech
- Tech Incubator Project Guidance

TECHNOLOGY & AI STACK

Enterprise AI: IBM Watson, MS Copilot, ChatGPT Enterprise, Google AI Studio, Gemini, NotebookLM

HCI & Design Tools: Figma, Miro, Mural, Design Tokens, FigJam

Engineering & Agile: Jira, Git, Confluence, Monday.com, Agile/Scrum

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

Samsung: 10-Year US Business Visa for driving global healthcare UX research.

Ericsson: Spot Award for sustaining UX innovation culture.

Ericsson: 1st Place, Global Hack-fest Optimization Contest.

Product Impact: Designed "Greedy Jump" iOS app (80K+ downloads).

Design Contests: 1st Place in MockingBOT & UP Labs UX Challenges.

PRODUCT DESIGN EXECUTIVE

18+ Years

HCI & AI Systems • Software Engineering Synergy

50+	5	1.5 Yrs
ENGINEERS MENTORED	TIER-1 GIANTS	TEACHING

ACADEMIC & PROFESSIONAL STATEMENT

Distinguished Technology and Product Design Leader with 18+ years of enterprise experience across IBM, Zebra Technologies, Ericsson, Samsung, and Infosys, grounded in a B.E. in Information Technology (MS University) and prior Anna University affiliated engineering college teaching experience. Seeking to serve as Professor of Practice at VIT Chennai's School of Computer Science & Engineering (SCOPE) to bridge computing theory and enterprise software practice. Expert in Human-Computer Interaction (HCI), enterprise AI integration (IBM Watson, GenAI), front-end architecture, and Agile engineering handoffs. Dedicated to mentoring students in real-world software engineering, guiding industry capstones, and expanding corporate placement pipelines.

ENTERPRISE PRACTICE & SOFTWARE LEADERSHIP

UI/UX Design — Senior Manager
Sep 2024 – Jan 2026
IBM Software Labs

- Integrated cutting-edge AI tools (Watson, GenAI) into day-to-day software design operations, upskilling multidisciplinary teams to accelerate development cycles and align UI execution with architectural goals.
- Architected AI-UX interaction models for IBM Watson in Rhapsody SE (system modeling) and MaaS360 (endpoint management), transforming complex backend protocols into intuitive user flows.
- Standardized AI governance and UX heuristics across software lab squads, mitigating runtime errors and deployment risks in enterprise mission-critical environments.
- Transitioned 12 designers into a centralized UX-as-a-Service model to optimize cross-functional delivery across global software engineering portfolios.

UI/UX Product Design Manager
Jul 2021 – Aug 2024
Zebra Technologies

- Directed multi-disciplinary engineering and design squads across B2B software and hardware portfolios; served as primary Hiring & Engineering Talent Mentor.
- Led Agile / PI planning sessions and Lean UX workshops, bridging technical constraints between engineering squads and product management.
- Codified design system tokens and reusable UI component architectures, accelerating engineering handoffs and ensuring high fidelity in production software builds.

UI/UX Senior Specialist
Oct 2020 – Jul 2021
ZF Wabco

- Led UX architecture for automotive infotainment and embedded fleet telematics, addressing complex system latency, hardware constraints, and driver safety standards.
- Mentored engineering teams on applying quantitative usability metrics and analytics to continuously optimize production software interfaces.

UI/UX Designer
Jul 2019 – Sep 2020
Ericsson Global

- Awarded 1st Place in Ericsson Global Hack-fest Optimization Contest for architecting high-efficiency technical solutions under intensive sprint deadlines.
- Standardized the global Ericsson Design System, establishing reusable code components that accelerated software development cycles.

Lead UI/UX Designer
Sep 2017 – Jul 2019
NP Compete Technologies

- Directed full product engineering and design cycles, overseeing sprint backlogs and technical feasibility across mobile and web platforms.

EARLIER EXPERIENCE

- **Creative Head** — Titi Technologies — May 2010 – Apr 2015
- **Senior Software Engineer** — Infosys Technologies — Jan 2006 – Apr 2010
- **Lecturer (IT)** — SKR Engg. College (Anna Univ. Affiliated) — May 2005 – Jan 2006
- **Teaching Faculty** — Computer Science & IT Department — Aug 2004 – Mar 2005